

County Administration Workshop: August 18, 2026

1:30 p.m. - Board of Commissioners Conference Room

Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

1. Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

Commissioners Richardson, Martin, and Smith each declared no potential conflicts of interest.

2. Department Business

a. Finance

1. District Attorney Fee Schedule

Matthew Eide, Finance Director, reported that the District Attorney's fee schedule has not received a comprehensive update in approximately a decade. The proposed revisions would generally increase fees by about 20 percent to better reflect current County costs, eliminate some outdated charges, and modernize how records and evidence are provided, including greater use of flash drives and Evidence.com rather than videotapes or DVDs.

Mr. Eide stated that the proposed amounts were compared with other jurisdictions, including Jackson County, and are intended to recover the cost of providing services rather than generate profit. He will prepare the required public-facing packet and Board orders and schedule the matter for public comment. Finance is also reviewing fee schedules in other departments to determine when they were last updated and whether a more regular review cycle should be established. No formal action was taken.

2. Supplemental Budget Discussion

Mr. Eide updated the Board on potential staffing requests for a supplemental budget. Department leadership had been asked to identify only positions that represented a clear omission from the adopted budget or were supported by material new information received after adoption. Requests identified to date included a Code Administrator for Building and Safety; a Department Specialist for Community Corrections; a half-time Department Specialist for Veterans Affairs, approximately four hours per day Monday through Friday; an audit-focused position in Finance; and an additional Human Resources Analyst. Finance was still working with Solid Waste regarding its needs.

Finance expects the current staffing proposal to remain below the applicable 10-percent threshold, which would allow a more streamlined supplemental-budget process, subject to Budget Committee and Board review. Mr. Eide has contacted the Budget Committee and will bring the staffing package forward after that review. Non-staff supplemental-budget requests are not being advanced at this time and may be reconsidered during the mid-year financial review.

The Board discussed the proposed Finance audit position and supported stronger internal controls, including timely completion of County audit work, review of grant recipients to verify that County-awarded funds are used for their intended purposes, and periodic departmental reviews. Commissioners discussed the value of an ongoing internal audit program compared with the cost and public perception of outside audits.

The Board also discussed keeping authorized full-time-equivalent counts aligned with actual staffing costs, particularly when compensation or benefit changes affect what a department can reasonably fill within its appropriation. Finance explained that FTE counts can be reduced without increasing total spending, and the Board emphasized that budgeted FTE should accurately reflect positions the County can actually hire. No formal action was taken.

b. Human Resources

1. Collective Bargaining Agreements

a. Josephine County Sheriff's Association of Sergeants

Natalie Eckhardt-Doupe, Interim Human Resources Director, presented the negotiated collective bargaining agreement for the Sheriff's Association of Sergeants. Human Resources reported that bargaining had concluded, the union had ratified and signed the agreement, and the contract would be effective for a three-year term.

A motion was made and seconded to approve the collective bargaining agreement between Josephine County and the Sheriff's Association of Sergeants. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

b. Josephine County Sheriff's Association

Ms. Eckhardt-Doupe presented the negotiated collective bargaining agreement for the Sheriff's Association, explaining that the association and the Sergeants unit are separate bargaining units and that both agreements were negotiated for three-year terms.

The Board discussed the long-term cost of employee benefits. Commissioner Richardson stated that, while he supported the negotiated agreement, the County should continue evaluating benefit structures over time and compare them with broader norms. Human Resources explained that the Sheriff's Association has long maintained health coverage outside OEBB and discussed reestablishing the County health insurance benefits committee, which had been active before COVID, to obtain broader employee input on future health-benefit decisions.

A motion was made and seconded to approve the collective bargaining agreement between Josephine County and the Sheriff's Association. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

2. Position Requisitions**a. Juvenile Justice - Group Life Counselor Lead Job Description Update**

Human Resources presented an update to the Group Life Counselor Lead classification in Juvenile Justice. The classification had not received a major update since approximately 2020. The revised duties would give lead employees clearer responsibility for training lower-level Group Life Counselors, assigning and overseeing shift tasks, and providing an accountable lead presence within the detention setting while supervisors continue to oversee broader staffing and management functions.

The Board approved the Group Life Counselor Lead job-description changes without objection.

b. Sheriff's Office - Corrections Corporal Vacancy

Human Resources requested authorization to begin recruitment for a Corrections Corporal position expected to become vacant within approximately two weeks. The discussion addressed the Sheriff's Office preference to begin with internal candidates because of their familiarity with department procedures and the retention value of promotional opportunities. Commissioners also emphasized that internal advancement should be balanced with the responsibility to select the best-qualified candidate.

The Board authorized recruitment to refill the Corrections Corporal position without objection.

c. Information Technology Director - Vacant Position and Job Description

Human Resources requested authorization to recruit for the Information Technology Director position following the separation of Information Technology and Emergency Management into distinct departments. Both departments currently have interim leadership. Under the revised personnel policy, director-level vacancies are to be publicly posted to obtain the broadest qualified applicant pool; the current interim director may apply.

The Board discussed the value of internal advancement as well as the distinct management responsibilities of department directors. Commissioners agreed that internal candidates should receive full consideration, but director recruitment should remain open so the County can select the best-qualified candidate for the organization's future needs.

The Board authorized recruitment for the Information Technology Director position and the related job-description changes without objection.

3. Board Business**a. Court Security Committee - Appointment of Commissioner**

Legal Counsel Wally Hicks discussed the need for active County participation with the courts on courthouse security matters. Because the subject involves security planning, he limited operational detail and noted that future reports may appropriately be handled in Executive Session. The discussion included the County's responsibility to provide and maintain court facilities while the State funds court operations, and the importance of coordinating with court partners at both County court facilities.

Commissioner Martin volunteered to serve as the Board's representative on the Court Security Committee. The Board also supported participation by Legal Counsel, if permitted by the courts, and involvement by the Facilities Director. The nomination was seconded. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Commissioner Martin was appointed to the Court Security Committee by a 3-0 vote.

b. House Bill 4084 Infrastructure Planning Grant

Commissioner Richardson provided a preliminary update on a potential House Bill 4084/Business Oregon grant application for infrastructure planning in the Illinois Valley. The proposed project would evaluate water and sewer infrastructure options serving the Cave Junction, Kerby, Illinois Valley Airport, and nearby mill-site areas, including existing system capacity and potential future configurations that could support economic development.

Staff and Commissioner Richardson are coordinating with Public Works, the City of Cave Junction, airport interests, and other local partners. A Board motion or resolution of support is not strictly required to apply but was described as helpful to the application. Because the application deadline is in early September, the Board agreed without objection that work should continue and directed that a formal support item be brought to an upcoming Weekly Business Session for public consideration.

c. Rural Workforce Partnership / Rogue Valley Workforce Consortium

Mary Lockwood, Executive Director of Rural Workforce Partnership, presented three proposed governing documents: an intergovernmental agreement between Josephine and Jackson counties, bylaws for the Rogue Valley Workforce Consortium, and a partnership agreement among the consortium, Rural Workforce Partnership staff, and the workforce development board. She described the organization as the regional Workforce Development Board serving Jackson and Josephine counties and explained its role in directing federal workforce-development funds to training, education, and industry partnerships.

Commissioners requested additional information before considering the agreements, including Legal Counsel review, the organization's current budget and financial condition, historical information regarding Josephine County's prior withdrawal or nonparticipation, and measurable results showing how many Josephine County residents have obtained employment or training through the organization. The Board also discussed the governance structure, federal WIOA funding, and how funds are delivered into Josephine County without passing through the County government.

During the discussion, it was clarified for the record that Josephine County is not presently a member of the consortium and has not assumed liability through the organization. Ms. Lockwood acknowledged that Commissioner Richardson's prior participation had occurred under a misunderstanding and that votes he cast were voided because Josephine County was not a member. Legal Counsel also referenced pending threatened litigation in emphasizing the importance of accurately stating the County's present status.

The Board took no action on the proposed agreements. The documents will be reviewed by Legal Counsel, and Rural Workforce Partnership will provide requested budget, performance, and historical information before the matter returns for consideration.

4. Other (ORS 192.640(1) - Commissioners may introduce other matters for consideration by the entire Board)**Communications Priorities Update**

Thomas Gray, Web and Public Information Coordinator, provided a communications-workload and priorities update and requested regular check-ins with the Board so that competing departmental needs can be prioritized by the Board as a body. Mr. Gray reported that he currently supports communications for nearly two dozen departments in addition to public-records responsibilities.

Current priorities include completion of the County Strategic Communications Plan, targeted for the end of September; updates to the social-media policy; implementation of improved public-records software and an updated public-records policy with guidance from the State Public Records Advocate; rollout of Loomly for coordinated social-media management; and acquisition of social-media archiving software to improve records retention and moderation compliance.

Mr. Gray also identified immediate work involving Firewise and Emergency Management outreach, including promotion of defensible-space grant opportunities and development of emergency-alert video materials; Economic Development Committee communications; the County's AI pilot work with Information Technology and the Treasury Department, including procedures and measurements for efficiency gains; and website accessibility. He reported that the County website appears to be approximately 85 to 90 percent compliant with current accessibility requirements and anticipated approximately six months of work to meet the stated April 2027 federal deadline while also improving usability.

Future communications work discussed included Community Justice data visualization and public education regarding juvenile-justice funding, video explaining the Clerk's election-counting process, and a Public Health communications plan tied to emergency-planning grant requirements. The Board encouraged Mr. Gray to consider limited contracted video or

production assistance if needed rather than allowing workload to become unmanageable, and emphasized that legal compliance and clear Board-level direction should remain the primary considerations when priorities compete.

Commissioners expressed support for the weekly County updates and for continued regular communications check-ins. No formal action was taken.

5. Additional Subject Matters from Commissioners/Announcements

Chair Smith reminded the public that fire season remained ongoing and urged continued caution.

The meeting adjourned at 3:07 p.m.